

LAB 13: UX Evaluation Methods

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Evaluation Methods

In this lab, students will explore various methods for evaluating the user experience and identifying usability issues in websites or apps. The lab aims to provide students with a solid understanding of how to assess the usability of a digital product and provide recommendations for improvement.

The lab will cover heuristic evaluations, which involve evaluating a website or app against a set of established usability heuristics. Students will learn about commonly used heuristics, such as Nielsen's 10 usability heuristics, and how to apply them to identify potential usability issues.

Tasks:

In this lab, students will have the opportunity to apply their knowledge of design in a practical setting. The lab tasks include:

Conduct a heuristic evaluation of a website or app using established usability heuristics

- 1) Begin by selecting a website or app that you want to evaluate. It can be an existing website/app or a prototype that you have developed.
- 2) Familiarize yourself with established usability heuristics such as Nielsen's 10 usability heuristics or other relevant heuristics specific to your project.
- 3) Evaluate the website or app by systematically going through each heuristic and examining how well it adheres to the principles outlined in the heuristic.
- 4) Identify areas where the website or app falls short in meeting the usability heuristics. These areas could include issues related to navigation, information architecture, clarity of instructions, error prevention, and more.
- 5) Document your findings by taking detailed notes or creating a usability evaluation checklist. Note down specific examples and screenshots to support your observations.

Perform a cognitive walkthrough to assess the user experience from a user's perspective

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- 1) Choose a specific task or scenario that represents a typical user interaction with the website or app you are evaluating.
- 2) Put yourself in the mindset of user and imagine how they would approach the task.
- 3) Step through the user flow, considering each action the user would take and the system's response at each step.
- 4) Identify potential issues or points of confusion that the user may encounter during the task. Document your findings by taking notes on the user's thought process, and areas where the user might need additional guidance or feedback.

Document and analyze the identified usability issues

- 1) Review the findings from both the heuristic evaluation and cognitive walkthrough.
- 2) Organize the identified usability issues into categories based on common themes or areas of concern.
- 3) Prioritize the usability issues based on their severity and impact on the overall UX.
- 4) Analyze each usability issue in detail, providing a clear description of the problem, its impact on the user, and possible causes.
- 5) Support your analysis with relevant evidence, such as screenshots or examples from website or app.

Develop a usability evaluation report with recommendations for improvement

- 1) Compile the findings and analysis into a comprehensive usability evaluation report.
- 2) Begin the report with an introduction that outlines the purpose of the evaluation, the methods used, and the scope of the evaluation.
- 3) Present the identified usability issues, categorizing them based on severity or impact.
- 4) Provide detailed descriptions of each usability issue, explaining why it is a problem and how it affects the user experience.
- 5) Offer specific recommendations for improvement, providing actionable steps that can be taken to address each usability issue.
- 6) Consider including visual aids such as annotated screenshots or wireframes to illustrate the identified issues and proposed solutions.